

blocked users from supporting the site. Satoshi wrote, “No, don’t ‘bring it on’. The project needs to grow gradually so the software can be strengthened along the way. I make this appeal to WikiLeaks not to try to use Bitcoin. Bitcoin is a small beta community in its infancy. You would not stand to get more than pocket change, and the heat you would bring would likely destroy us at this stage.”³¹

Shortly thereafter, Satoshi vanished. Some speculate it was for the good of Bitcoin. After all, being the creator of a technology that has the potential to replace much of the current financial system is bound eventually to invoke the wrath of powerful government and private sector forces. By disappearing into the ether, Satoshi removed the head of Bitcoin, and with it a single point of failure. In his wake stands a network with thousands of access points and millions of users.

Wall Street, on the other hand, suffered from many points of failure. When the dust settled, the U.S. government had spent well beyond the \$700 billion initially secured for TARP. In all, \$2.5 trillion was injected into the system, not to mention \$12.2 trillion committed to reinstall faith in the fidelity of financial institutions.³²

While Wall Street as we knew it was experiencing an expensive death, Bitcoin’s birth cost the world nothing. It was born as an open-source technology and quickly abandoned like a motherless babe in the world. Perhaps, if the global financial system had been healthier, there would have been less of a community to support Bitcoin, which ultimately allowed it to